

THE HOLY SPIRIT: BAPTISM & GIFTS

Message by Pastor Dave Labdon

On Sunday we focused on the gifts of the Holy Spirit and baptism in Him. In this reflection we unpack the baptism of the Holy Spirit in our lives and seek to discern what gifts we have and what gifts we will ask the Lord for.

BAPTISM OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

At Pentecost Peter called the crowd, and us, to repent, be baptised (believe) in Jesus for forgiveness and the Holy Spirit will be given and received (Acts 2: 38); this is true for all believers (Acts 2: 39). This is the fulfilment of Jesus', John's and Paul's words explaining that they and we would be baptised by the Spirit into the body of Christ (Matt. 3: 11, Acts 1: 5 & 1 Cor. 12: 13). Is this a step of faith you have taken? Have you been born of the Spirit (John 3: 3 & 5) and does the Holy Spirit now dwell in you (1 Cor. 6: 19); how is this impacting your life and relationships with the Lord and church?

Type your response here...

Once the Holy Spirit lives within us there can be times when we experience a further infilling of the Holy Spirit for a specific need or event (Luke 1: 67, Acts 4: 8). The infilling of the Holy Spirit can also help us to grow in Christlikeness (Acts 6: 3, 11: 24 & Gal. 5: 22-23). Have you experienced an occasion when the Holy Spirit has empowered you specifically? Do you sense the growth of the fruits of the Spirit as He develops you?

Type your response here...

THE GIFTS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

When we consider the gifts God bestows, we see that they are given to all, for the common good, blessing of the Church and God's glory; they are to be used not lost (1 Cor. 12: 4-7, 11 & Matt 25: 14-30). There are gifts of service, working (activities and/or abilities) and spiritual gifts. We saw that there are nine gifts of the Spirit, three each within the three categories of Revelation, Vocal and Power gifts (1 Cor. 12: 8-10).

These gifts are now all detailed below. Consider each one, can you think of examples in the New Testament? Ask the Lord to show you if they are a gift you have or a gift He would like you to have? What is the gift to be used for?

N.B. Some of the definitions and explanations are taken or adapted from work by Derek Prince

Revelation Gifts

A Word of Wisdom — 1 Cor. 12: 8: a tiny portion of God's wisdom given supernaturally by the Holy Spirit for a given purpose

Type your response here...

A Word of Knowledge — 1 Cor. 12: 8: a specific piece of knowledge from God that brings about a conviction of the truth, it can confirm something that God has been showing by other means and sometimes it prepares us for the future

Type your response here...

The ability to discern spirits — 1 Cor. 12: 10c: the ability to discern and recognise the difference between spirits (mainly angels, fallen angels, demonic and human)

Type your response here...

The Power Gifts

Faith by the Spirit — 1 Cor. 12: 9: a gift of Faith is the impartation of divine faith to a person in a particular situation for the common good

Type your response here...

Gifts of Healings and Miracles — 1 Cor. 12: 9b & 10a: a healing that relieves the body of disease or injury that may be gradual, instantaneous or even imperceptible. A miracle is a specific manifestation of the gift, a God given ability which demonstrates the supernatural power of the Holy Spirit at work

Type your response here...

The Vocal Gifts

The Gifts of Tongues & Interpretation — 1 Cor. 12: 10d: the ability given by the Holy Spirit to speak in a language not understood by the speaker. The ability given by the Holy Spirit to speak, in a language understood by the speaker, the meaning of the words previously spoken in an unknown language

Type your response here...

The Gift of Prophecy — 1 Cor. 12: 10b (Forthtelling and Foretelling 1 Cor 14: 1-5): the ability to speak words given by the Holy Spirit in a language understood by the speaker

Type your response here...

The Lord wants us to desire these gifts, especially the greater ones (1 Cor. 12: 31). We are to ask for them persistently and in faith (Luke 11: 1-13). Once received we are called to use them by remaining in Him and producing fruit for His glory (Matt 25: 14-30, John 15: 7-8). Based on this reflection what is the Lord asking you to do; desire, pray for and/or act upon?

Type your response here...

"Therefore you do not lack any spiritual gift as you eagerly wait for our Lord Jesus Christ to be revealed." 1 Corinthians 1: 7

Please feel free to speak to Pastors Andaza or Dave on any of these topics